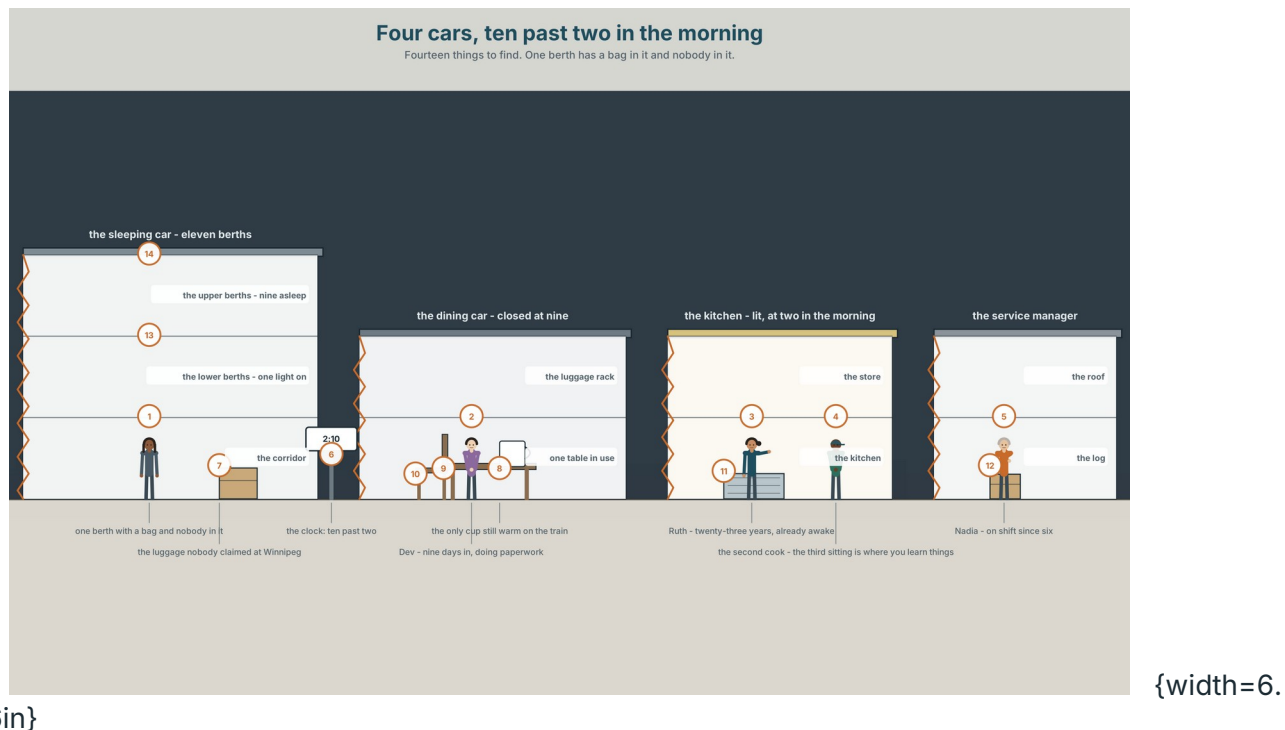


Table of Contents

A1.2 • Unit 1 • Nine Days In

English Animated • *Getting Around* • The Prairie Line, Toronto to Vancouver Student's Book
pages 6–27 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

Four cars, ten past two in the morning — Fourteen things to find. One berth has a bag in it and nobody in it.

What happened at work yesterday?

By the end of this unit you can tell somebody what happened, in order.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

A train crossing a continent, where nobody on board can go home at the end of a shift

the past simple of irregular verbs • 22 words for work on a train • the words that put a story in order • the vowel that changes inside an irregular verb
You tell the story of one shift that

◆ A • THE WORLD

A train crossing a continent, where
nobody on board can go home at the
end of a shift
went wrong, in sixty seconds

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a passenger ☐ a seat ☐ a ticket ☐ a window ☐ a bag ☐ a door ☐ a table ☐ a light ☐ a kitchen ☐ a clock ☐ a bed ☐ a corridor ☐ a cup ☐ a notebook

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

the crew · a delay · a report

0B • Guess it

Look at the person doing paperwork at two in the morning. **Why is he not asleep?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

work · late · busy · problem · write

0C • Say it

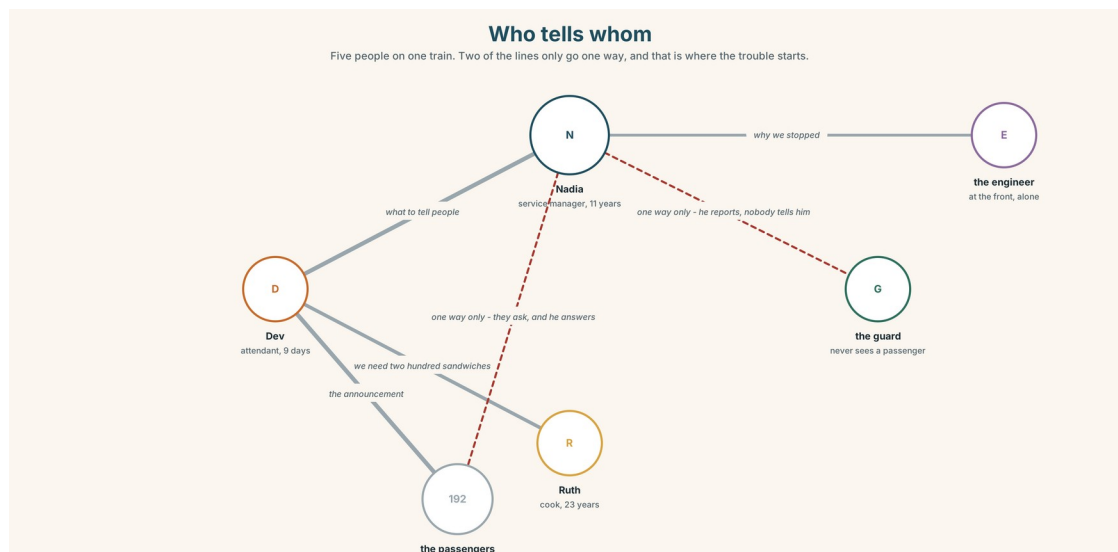
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

Tell me about yesterday. What happened?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — a shift on the Prairie Line



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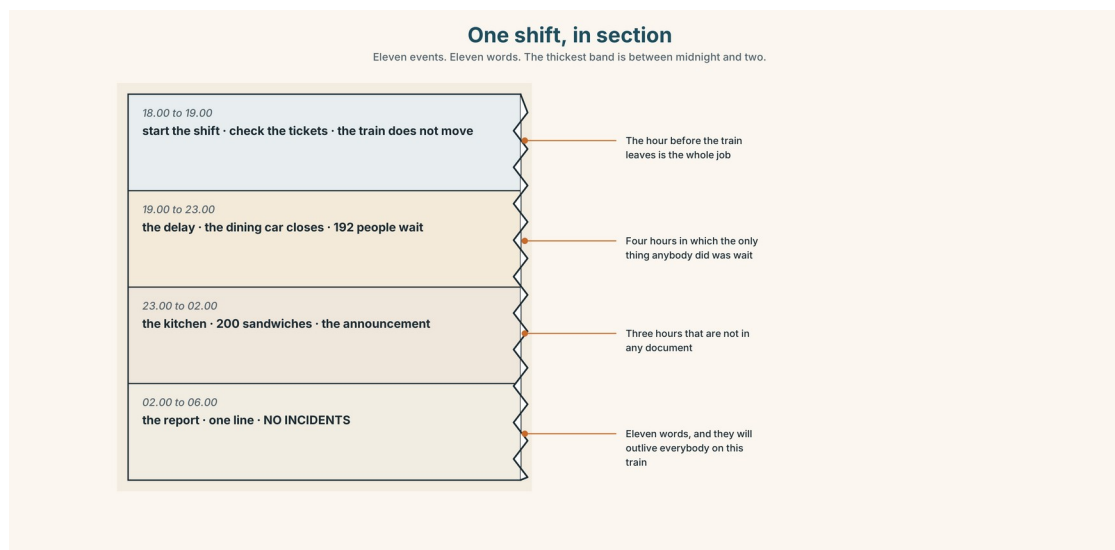
Who tells whom — Five people on one train. Two of the lines only go one way, and that is where the trouble starts.

shift	Twelve hours, and you cannot leave the building, because the building is moving.
crew	Six people. Four of them never see the passengers.
passenger	A hundred and ninety-two. Eleven of them will ask the same question.
delay	Four hours. It was nobody's fault and it is somebody's problem.
report	One page. It has a box for what went wrong and no box for anything else.
mistake	The only thing on this list that gets written down every time.

1B • Meet — the words

arrive • leave • begin • happen • passenger • crew • ticket • seat • delay • shift • report • mistake • lucky • awful • busy • calm

Write each word under the right picture.



6in}

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One shift, in section — Eleven events. Eleven words. The thickest band is between midnight and two.

1C • Sort — the job, or how it felt?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which two, and why?**

delay • lucky • shift • awful • crew • busy • report • calm • mistake • ticket

PART OF THE JOB**HOW IT FELT****BOTH****1D • What a crew actually does**

start the shift	At six. The train leaves at seven, and the hour between is the whole job.
check the tickets	Twice. Once for the company and once to find out who is where.
serve the meals	Three sittings. The third one is where you learn things.
make an announcement	Thirty seconds, to a hundred and ninety-two people, with no second chance.
turn up	The single most important thing anybody on this list does.
sort out	What the report calls <i>resolution</i> and what everybody else calls Tuesday.

Now say them. Four of these six have a word in the middle you could remove. **Which two cannot lose anything, and why not?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

start the shift · make an announcement · turn up · sort out · What happened?

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. A hundred and ninety-two people need to know something now. → _____
2. Somebody comes back to work after being ill. → _____
3. It is six in the evening and you put your jacket on. → _____
4. Two passengers have the same seat number. → _____
5. Your colleague looks terrible and you want to know why. → _____

1F • The hard one

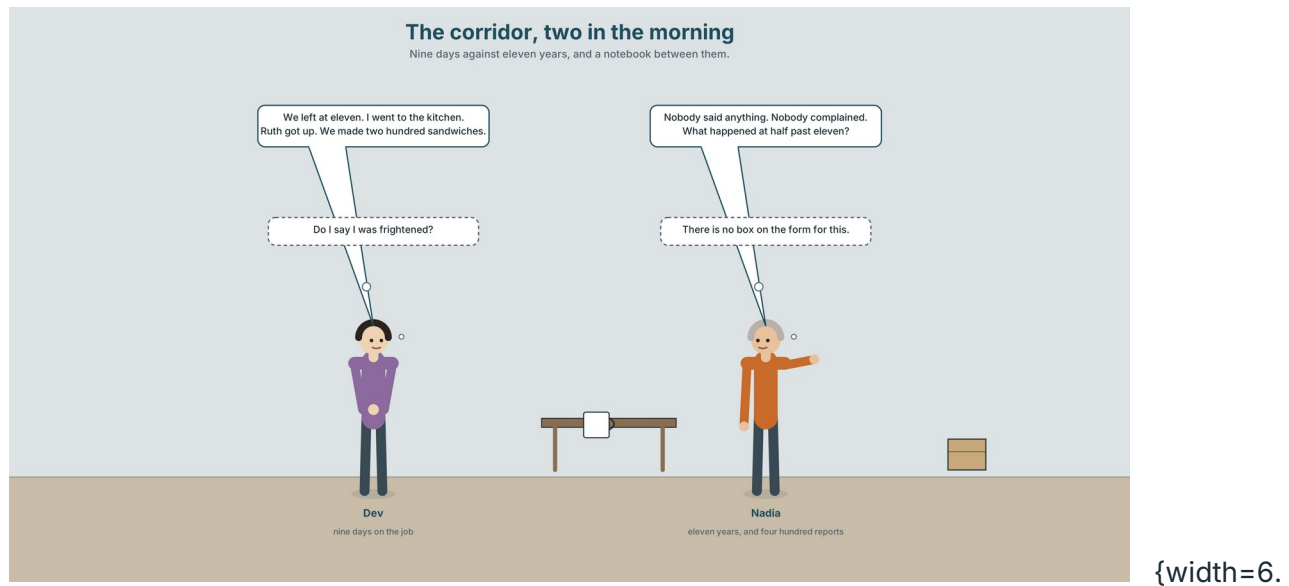
f You'll never believe it.

Practise it three times. **Four words that tell the listener a story is coming and they should stop doing whatever they are doing.**

1G • Own it

Write down three things that happened at your work or your school yesterday. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose day it is.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

The corridor, two in the morning — Nine days against eleven years, and a notebook between them.

2A • Two in the morning 🎧 Track 1.1

Before you listen. Dev has worked here for nine days. The train was four hours late. **Guess: whose fault was it?**

Listen once. One question. What time did the train leave?

Listen again. Put the events in order.

	Event
1	
2	
3	
4	

Listen again. True or false?

- The train left on time. ☐ T ☐ F
- Dev made an announcement. ☐ T ☐ F
- Nadia was asleep when it happened. ☐ T ☐ F
- Nobody complained. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- We left at eleven.*
- I went to the kitchen.*
- She came back with Ruth.*
- Nobody said anything.*

None of these four verbs has -ed on it. What happened to them instead?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 1.2

Twenty seconds of Dev at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. Count the past verbs you hear.
- 2. *Went, came* and *said* are all one syllable. Which vowel is longest?
- 3. He says one sequence word four times. Which one, and what is he using it for?

Transcripts, page 148.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The verbs that change inside

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. What is the present form of each of the four verbs?
- 2. What changed — the beginning, the middle or the end?
- 3. Is the form the same after *I, she* and *they*?
- 4. Which of the four would you guess wrongly if you had never seen it?

3B • See

Bolted on, or changed inside

A regular verb grows a piece at the end. An irregular one changes in the middle.

arriv

+ ed

c

a

me

go → went

regular

bolted on

irregular

the vowel moves

and the rest stays

no pattern at all

Regular: the word is untouched and something is added. Irregular: nothing is added and the inside changes. About 180 verbs do the second thing, and they are the 180 you will use most often.

6in}

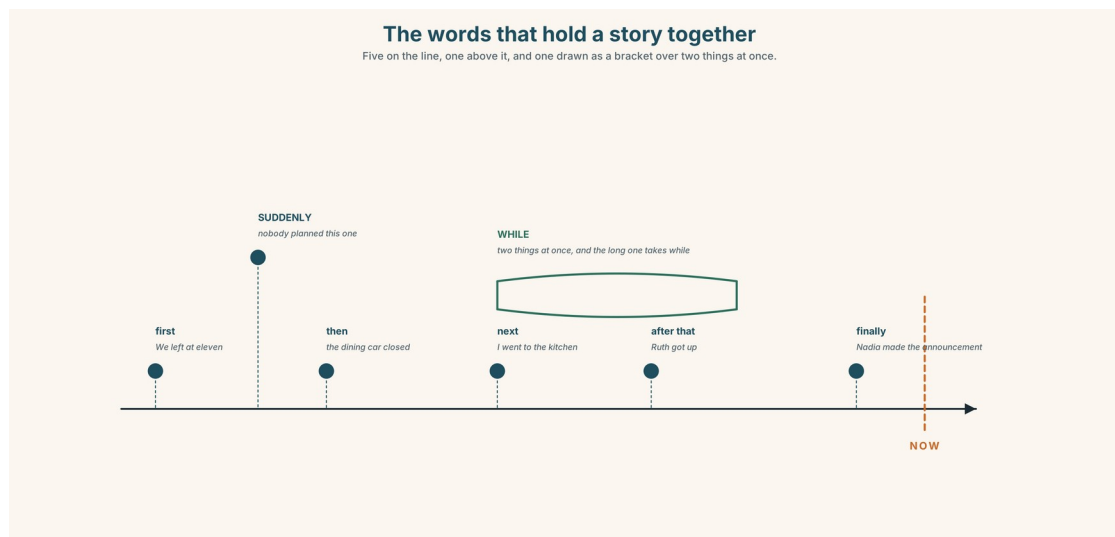
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Bolted on, or changed inside — A regular verb grows a piece at the end. An irregular one changes in the middle.

3C • Know

regular	add -ed , nothing moves	<i>arrive</i> → <i>arrived</i> · <i>happen</i> → <i>happened</i>
the vowel changes	the middle of the word	<i>come</i> → <i>came</i> · <i>begin</i> → <i>began</i> · <i>sit</i> → <i>sat</i>
the whole word changes	no pattern at all	<i>go</i> → <i>went</i> · <i>be</i> → <i>was/were</i>
nothing changes	the commonest trap	<i>put</i> → <i>put</i> · <i>cut</i> → <i>cut</i> · <i>let</i> → <i>let</i>

One form for all six persons. *I went, you went, she went, we went, they went.* The past simple is the only tense in English with no person endings at all, which makes it easier than the present and harder to believe.



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6in}

The words that hold a story together — Five on the line, one above it, and one drawn as a bracket over two things at once.

in order

first · then · next · after that · finally

at the same time

while

out of order

suddenly · at first · in the end · the next day

Why it matters. Half of everything anybody says to anybody is a story about yesterday, and the listener is building a line while you speak. Give them the order or they build it wrong.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the past of the verb.

We (1) _____ (leave) at eleven, four hours late. I (2) _____ (go) to the kitchen and Ruth (3) _____ (be) already awake. Nadia (4) _____ (come) back with two sandwiches. Nobody (5) _____ (say) anything. It (6) _____ (begin) as a bad night and it (7) _____ (become) a good one.

3E • Use — guided

Put each sentence into the past.

1. The train leaves at seven.
2. I go to the kitchen.
3. She comes back with Ruth.
4. We begin the shift at six.
5. Nobody says anything.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Tell your partner about one day last week, in six sentences. **Use a sequence word in every sentence. Your partner draws the line as you speak.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. We _____ (leave) at eleven.
2. I _____ (go) to the kitchen.
3. She _____ (come) back at two.
4. Nobody _____ (say) anything.
5. × *We leaved at eleven.* → correct it.
6. × *He goed to the kitchen.* → correct it.

The ending on a word that had already changed

✗ He goed to the kitchen.

+ ed, on a word that does not take it

go

The -ed rule is real and it covers most verbs, so the ear reaches for it. But go has already made its past by replacing itself completely. Adding the ending is like paying twice: the listener hears the correction before they hear the meaning.

✓ He went to the kitchen.

one word, and no ending at all

went

Went is the past of go and it shares no letters with it. There is no rule to learn here and nothing to work out - it is one of about ten verbs in English whose past is a different word, and all ten are among the commonest words in the language.

What the writer thought:
Irregular verbs feel like exceptions to be memorised later. They are not the edge of the language, they are the middle of it: the twenty commonest verbs in English are almost all irregular, because the words people use most often are the ones that resist tidying up.

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6in}

The ending on a word that had already changed — The ending on a word that had already changed

0-3 → Workbook pp. 4-7. **4-5** → Part 6. **6** → page 24.

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — the chain story

The first person says one sentence in the past. The next adds one, starting with a sequence word. **No sequence word twice. Stop when somebody uses a regular verb.**

4B • The functional core — telling what happened

The same four hours, told twice

On the left, the order things happened. On the right, the order they were remembered.

in order

19.00 · 21.00 · 23.00 · 00.30 — four times, in order

as remembered

the sandwiches · oh and before that · no wait — no times at all

Find the six. One of the two can be followed by somebody who was not there. Which, and what is it that the other one is missing?

6 differences — find them all

6in}{width=6.

The same four hours, told twice — On the left, the order things happened. On the right, the order they were remembered.

Language Bank

opening it	You'll never believe it. · So, yesterday...
in order	first · then · next · after that · finally
the interruption	and then suddenly...
closing it	in the end · and that was it

Information gap. Learner A has what the crew did. Learner B has what the passengers saw. Build one timeline of the four hours.

4C • The performance — one shift

Tell the story of one hour that went wrong — at work, at school, anywhere. One minute. You must:

- use four sequence words · use three irregular past verbs · say one thing you felt · end with what happened in the end

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person listens for one thing: did the story stay in order?

4E • Two criteria

- Did I use at least three irregular past verbs correctly? Could somebody who was not there draw my timeline?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Four hours, and one line in the log.**" What do you think the one line says?

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Four hours, and one line in the log

The train left Toronto four hours late. A freight train broke down eighty kilometres ahead and nobody could go anywhere until it moved.

Dev had been on the job for nine days. At eleven at night a hundred and ninety-two people had been sitting in a stationary train since seven, and the dining car had closed at nine.

He went to the kitchen and woke Ruth. She was not pleased. Then she got up, and between them they made two hundred sandwiches in ninety minutes. Nadia made an announcement at half past eleven and told everybody exactly what she knew, which was not much, and said it anyway.

Nobody complained. Three people wrote to the company to say so.

The company log for that night says: **DELAY 4H — FREIGHT. NO INCIDENTS.**

5C • Answer

1. How late was the train?
2. Why was it late?
3. How long had Dev worked there?
4. How many sandwiches did they make?
5. **Why did Nadia make the announcement when she did not have much to tell them?**
6. **The log says NO INCIDENTS. Is that true, and what is it missing?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

broke down • stationary • she was not pleased • between them • said it anyway

5E • The counter-text

The crew log for that night

Nine boxes. Eight of them are numbers and the ninth says NONE.

PRAIRIE LINE - CREW LOG - TRAIN 062

FIELD	ENTRY	BY
DATE	14 MAY	N.O.
SCHEDULED DEP.	19.00	--
ACTUAL DEP.	23.04	N.O.
DELAY	4 H 04	AUTO
REASON CODE	F3 - FREIGHT	N.O.
ARRIVAL	+3 H 51	AUTO
CREW ON DUTY	6	AUTO
PASSENGERS	192	AUTO

INCIDENTS

NONE

Signed	N. Okafor, Service Manager
Time signed	02.41

Reason code F3 means the delay was caused by a freight movement. It records the cause and not the fault, which is deliberate: the company has twenty-two reason codes and none of them names anybody.

Four hours and four minutes, measured by a machine

F3. A cause, and carefully not a person

A hundred and ninety-two, counted automatically

The one box a human had to think about, and it says NONE

Signed at twenty to three, after a twelve-hour shift

6in}

The crew log for that night — Nine boxes. Eight of them are numbers and the ninth says NONE.

Read the log and answer.

1. What time did the train leave, and what time was it supposed to leave?
2. **What is the reason code, and does it say whose fault it was?**
3. What is written in the INCIDENTS box?
4. **Three people wrote to the company. Where on this page would that appear?**

5F • Two texts

The reading describes two hundred sandwiches and one announcement. The log describes a four-hour delay and no incidents.

Which one will still exist in ten years? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Putting a story in order

Four hours, six panels
Each panel carries its own sequence word. Only one of them was planned by nobody.

1 FIRST - 19.00, the train does not move	2 THEN - 21.00, the dining car closes	3 NEXT - 23.00, Dev goes to the kitchen	4 SUDDENLY - Ruth gets up
5 AFTER THAT - 200 sandwiches	6 FINALLY - the announcement		

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6in}

Four hours, six panels — Each panel carries its own sequence word. Only one of them was planned by nobody.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

then / after that

both work; *after that* is slower and gives the listener a rest

at first

sets up a change that is coming. Never use it unless one is

in the end

the result, not the last event

while

two things at once, and the verb after it is usually the long one

6B • Say them

first • then • next • after that • finally • before • while • suddenly

6C • Chunk

1. ____ **that** — the slow version of *then*
2. **At** ____ — and something is going to change
3. **In the** ____ — the result
4. ____ **I was making the sandwiches...** — two things at once
5. **The** ____ **day** — and the story continues
6. ____ ____ ? — the two words that ask for the whole story

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **while** or **when**?

- _____ the train stopped, everybody looked up.
- _____ we were making sandwiches, Nadia made the announcement.
- _____ I arrived, the dining car was already closed.
- _____ Ruth was cooking, Dev was checking the tickets.
- _____ the freight train moved, we left.
- _____ the passengers were sleeping, the crew was working.

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The vowel in the middle

The vowel in the middle
The consonants do not move. One sound in the middle does all the work.

i → a	ee → e	a new word
the commonest change of all	the vowel gets shorter, not different	no pattern, and no help
begin → began sit → sat give → gave drink → drank swim → swam	meet → met feel → felt keep → kept read → read sleep → slept	go → went be → was / were put → put cut → cut let → let
the consonants on both sides are identical in every pair	read is spelled the same twice - only the length tells you which	the last three change nothing at all, which is the hardest kind to hear

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6in}

The vowel in the middle — The consonants do not move. One sound in the middle does all the work.

7A • Hear

i → a: begin → began · sit → sat · give → gave ee → e: meet → met · read → read · feel → felt
o → e: come → came · become → became — the spelling lies; listen to the sound

7B • Say

Say each pair three times. Then say this:

I came, I sat, I began. — three vowels, three verbs, no endings at all.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

I read it. — present. The vowel is long: *reed*. *I read it.* — past. The vowel is short: *red*.

Same five letters, same spelling, two tenses. The only thing that tells your listener which one you mean is a vowel that lasts a tenth of a second. Which is which?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six things that happened to you yesterday, all irregular verbs.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

What happened • 50–70 words

8A • Read the model

On Tuesday we left Toronto four hours late. [the fact, with a day and a number]

At first nobody minded. Then the dining car closed and people began to ask questions. [*at first*, and the change it promised]

I went to the kitchen and woke the cook. She wasn't pleased, but she got up. [two irregular verbs, and one honest detail]

In the end we made two hundred sandwiches. Nobody complained. [the result, and the proof]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. *At first nobody minded.* **What does that tell the reader is coming?**
2. *She wasn't pleased, but she got up.* **Why keep the first half?**
3. The last two sentences are six words long. **Why so short at the end?**

8B • The anti-model

On Tuesday the train was late. It was a difficult night. Everybody worked very hard. We did our best. In the end it was fine.

Correct English, and it could be any night on any train. **Add two numbers, one irregular verb and one thing that somebody actually said.**

8C • Plan

the fact, with a number → *at first*, and the change → what you did, with two irregular verbs → the result, short

8D • Write — 50 to 70 words

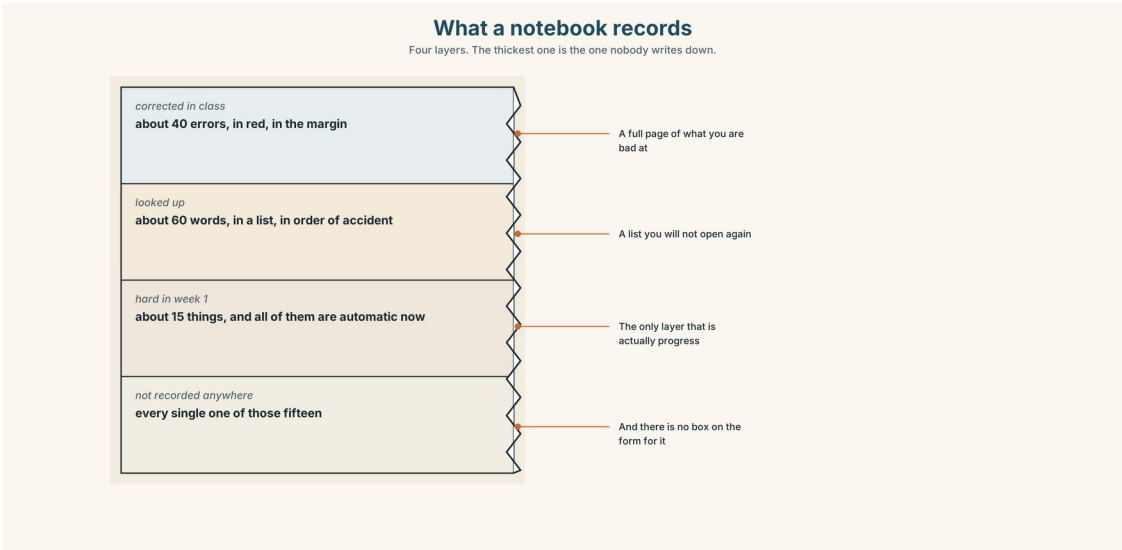
8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is the story in order, and can you draw it? ☐ Are there at least three irregular past verbs, all correct?

8F • Publish

On the wall, with no names. **The class puts them in order of how badly the night went.**

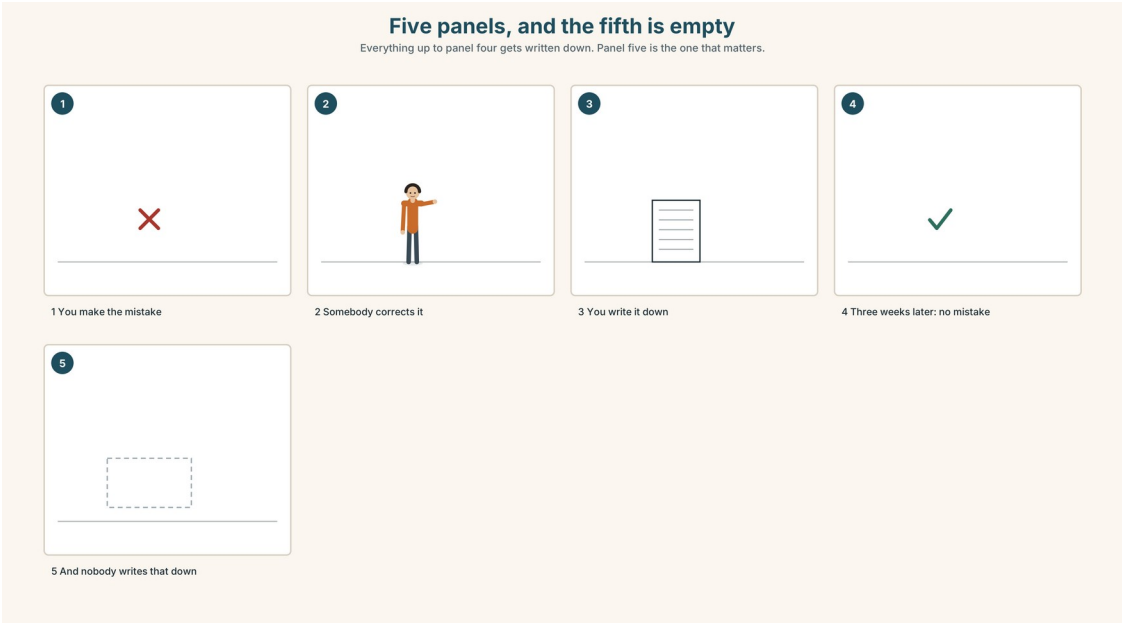
STUDY FILE • The log of what went right



6in}

What a notebook records — Four layers. The thickest one is the one nobody writes down.

9A • What gets written down



6in}

Five panels, and the fifth is empty — Everything up to panel four gets written down. Panel five is the one that matters.

What does not	every error you no longer make
What that does	a notebook full of things you are bad at
The fix	one line a week: <i>this week I stopped...</i>

9B • Your own log

At the end of each week, write **one sentence** in the past about something you could not do before and can do now. Not *better*. What, exactly.

Last week I didn't understand the announcements. On Thursday I understood one.

9C • Role play — the debrief

In pairs. One of you had a bad week. The other asks: *What happened?* and then, four times, *And then?* **The point is the sequence, not the sympathy.**

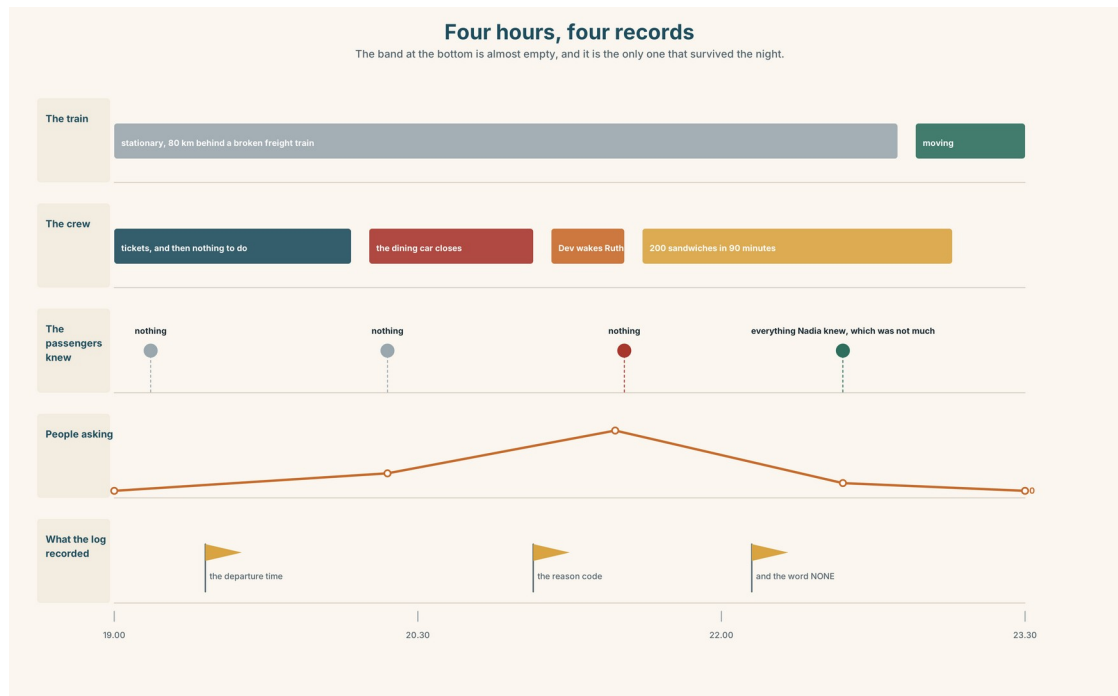
9D • The thing nobody wrote down

Think of one thing in your English that was hard in September and is not hard now. **Nobody recorded it. Record it.**

9E • Transfer — before next week

Write one sentence a day, in the past, about one English thing that happened. Seven sentences. Bring them.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



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6in}

Four hours, four records — The band at the bottom is almost empty, and it is the only one that survived the night.

10A • Relay

Half the class has what the crew did. Half has what the passengers knew. **Build the four hours by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

A new crew member asks: *What happened on Tuesday?* **Tell them in four sentences.** They need to be able to act on it, not enjoy it.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to a friend about something that happened to you this week. **Three sentences.** Two sequence words, one irregular verb.

10D • Your language

Does your language have irregular past verbs? **Say *I went* and *I arrived* in your language.** Do they change in the same place?

Part 11 • The Decision ◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

No incidents

The company's crew log has one box for what went wrong and no box for anything else.

On Tuesday the train was four hours late. Two people made two hundred sandwiches at midnight and one person told a hundred and ninety-two passengers the truth. The log says NO INCIDENTS, which is correct.

Option one: leave it. A log is for problems. Everything else is just the job.

Option two: add a box. Three lines, headed *what the crew did*. It takes ninety seconds to fill in at the end of a twelve-hour shift.

Option three: add the box and make it compulsory. Then it gets filled in, and then it gets filled in badly.

11A • The evidence

The same form, twice
On the left, the log as it is. On the right, three lines longer.

as it is	three lines longer
8 numbers · 1 word: NONE · signed 02.41	8 numbers · 3 lines of handwriting · signed 02.43
Find the six. One of them is the time at the bottom, and it is the argument against the whole idea.	
6 differences — find them all	

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6in}

The same form, twice — On the left, the log as it is. On the right, three lines longer.

 **Track 1.6.** Nadia, 20 seconds: "I've written four hundred of these. The box says incidents. Nothing went wrong, so I wrote none. Everything that happened that night was not an incident."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: report · crew · shift · delay · mistake · passenger · lucky

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Add the box and leave it optional. A compulsory box produces four hundred identical sentences. An optional one gets filled in on the nights when there is something to say, and those are exactly the nights you want to read about.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The company added three optional lines. In the first six months the box was filled in on about one night in nine, which the company thought was a failure.

Then something nobody expected: when a new crew member joined, the first thing they were given was the last twenty filled-in boxes. It had stopped being a record and become the only training document on the line.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The company wanted a record. What did it build instead?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. We _____ (leave) at eleven.
2. I _____ (go) to the kitchen.
3. She _____ (come) back at two.
4. Nobody _____ (say) anything.
5. It _____ (begin) at seven.
6. _____ that, everything was quiet. (*the slow version of then*)
7. _____ first, nobody minded.
8. In the _____, nobody complained.
9. _____ I was in the kitchen, Nadia made the announcement.
10. The _____ day, three people wrote to the company.
11. I need to _____ this _____. (*two words — fix a problem*)
12. _____ _____ ? (*the two words that ask for a story*)

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write six sentences about one hour of one day last week. Four irregular past verbs, four sequence words, one thing you felt, and the result at the end.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can tell what happened, in order. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can use irregular past verbs. **Evidence:** 3G ☐ I can use sequence words. **Evidence:** 6C ☐ I can hear the vowel that changes inside a verb. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE PEOPLE • passenger • crew **THE THINGS** • ticket • seat • report • shift • delay **WHAT HAPPENS** • arrive • leave • begin • happen • mistake **HOW IT FELT** • lucky • awful • busy • calm

WHAT THE CREW DOES · start the shift · check the tickets · serve the meals · make an announcement · turn up · sort out **THE ORDER** · first · then · next · after that · finally · before · while · suddenly **OUT OF ORDER** · at first · in the end · the next day **ASKING AND OPENING** · What happened? · You'll never believe it.

12F • Next

Unit 2 • Why do people leave a place?